Northeastern University
Khoury College of Computer Sciences
CS 1200 Asynchronous (Online/ In-person) Course Syllabus

CS 1200: FIRST YEAR SEMINAR-INSTRUCTIONAL TEAM

Section: 22 Time: Thursdays 1:35pm -2:40pm
Room: [redacted]
Instructor: [redacted]
Email: [redacted]
Office Hours by Appointment: (email to set up a meeting or schedule an appointment via navigate).

Teaching Assistant: [redacted]
Major: [redacted]
Email: [redacted]

Note: Unless otherwise noted, you can expect a response from me within 24 hours during the week and 48 hours over the weekend.

COURSE OVERVIEW

This course supports students in their transition to Northeastern and in their holistic development as they become responsible members of the college and university communities. The course will incorporate large group discussion, small group activities, and self-reflection in order to facilitate connections with faculty, staff, and peers, promote utilization of appropriate campus resources, and to assist with academic and personal goal setting.

OUTCOMES AND OBJECTIVES

As a result of completing this course, you will:

1. Identify and use appropriate campus resources and engage in opportunities that contribute to their learning within and beyond the classroom
2. Develop positive relationships with peers, faculty, and staff
3. Evaluate strengths, abilities, and values and apply this self-knowledge to personal and academic goal setting

TEACHING ASSISTANT (TA) FOR CS 1200

The Teaching Assistant is an upper-level Khoury student that has been on at least one co-op. The role of the TA is to support the instructor as a mentor to first year students as they transition to Northeastern University. The TA is a knowledgeable resource for students to connect with if questions or issues arise. TAs are active in leading class discussion, answering questions, and assisting with the group project.

Your TAs will be running TA-led sessions on topics that they wish they knew in their first semester at Northeastern, and all students will be required to attend at least one for their Northeastern Network Map assignment.

TA One-On-One Assignment

You will meet with your TA for a one-on-one meeting, which provides a space for you to get to know them, to answer any questions you have, or assist you and your group with your Design Thinking project. Your TA will share their availability with you at the beginning of the semester so you can sign up for a meeting.

Grading Policy If you need to cancel your TA One-on-One session, please email your TA at least 12 hours ahead of your appointment. If you do so, you can reschedule and earn full credit for your meeting. If you do not notify your TA at least 12 hours prior to your meeting that you will not be attending OR you do not attend your scheduled meeting, you can reschedule but there is a 10% deduction in your highest possible grade. Each additional missed or non-cancelled will receive an additional 10% deduction in your highest possible grade.

HOW THE COURSE IS STRUCTURED

CS 1200 – First Year Seminar will run as a hybrid class, meaning we will hold both in-person and asynchronous class meetings. The course schedule will outline when the class will be held in-person and when it will be held asynchronously. You can find all materials in Canvas (canvas.northeastern.edu). You will need to log in using your Northeastern credentials.

Weekly Modules: There is a modules area for reviewing class content. Each module contains all you need for that week, including directions, readings, video viewings, and assignments. Click on *Modules* in the left-hand menu of the course website to access the materials. You may also access each week via the homepage in Canvas. Each weekly module includes some Exit Questions, a graded checkpoint to gauge your level of understanding and to mark your participation for the week. The Exit Questions are a part of the class participation grade.

Weekly Class Meetings

In-Person Class Meetings: When we meet in-person, it is expected that you have reviewed the module content from the previous week, as we will be discussing the content in class. Your attendance is mandatory and will be factored into your participation grade. Our class meetings will be interactive and activity-based, so it is essential that you come to class ready to connect with others and to contribute to the class discussions and conversations. Please bring your laptop to class, as you will be using class time to work with your Design Thinking Project group members.

Asynchronous Class Weeks: When we are not meeting in person, you will be working through Canvas modules that will cover required course content and your ongoing Design Thinking Project. While you will often have in-person class time to work with your group, we highly

advise that you use the weeks we are not meeting in person to check in with your group and ensure you are on track to complete each project task by the following week. Additionally, there will be some asynchronous weeks where you will be responsible for working through an entire portion of the project with your group members, so you will need to plan accordingly.

Managing Work in a Hybrid Class

There is a rhythm and pattern to work in a hybrid class. While one of the advantages of online learning is the flexibility it affords students in completing work, you will need to arrange your schedule according to the regular deadlines outlined in the chart below, setting aside several regular blocks of time each week to be "in class."

Working with your Design Thinking Project Group

In addition to following the recommended schedule above to complete your weekly assignments, you will be expected to meet with your group at least once a week. You will establish a meeting schedule with your group while completing the Group Ground Rules worksheet. Your group meeting time will be used to work through the Design Thinking Project and to complete the associated worksheets and final presentation. As mentioned earlier, we highly advise that you use the weeks we are not meeting in person to check in with your group and ensure you are on track to complete each project task by the following week.

AN IMPORTANT NOTE ON TIME AND INVOLVEMENT IN A HYBRID COURSE

It may be tempting to think that a hybrid course will be less time-consuming than a fully face-to-face class. Please don't make that mistake. In fact, your in-person and remote class weeks will require the same amount of time, except that during remote weeks much of your work will be done independently – writing and reading, viewing materials, etc. You will take an active role that requires discipline and time management.

Schedule approximately 2-3 hours a week for classwork, even more in weeks with major assignments.

ATTENDANCE POLICY

Attendance is mandatory for all in-person class sessions. Since we only have 7 in-person sessions, it is essential that we all attend in order to connect and engage with class material. Class attendance factors into your course participation grade:

- For each class you attend, you earn 4 points towards your participation grade.
- If you miss a class session, you will earn 0 points.
- If you contact your instructor prior to the in-person class time to notify them you will not be in class, you will earn 2 points towards your participation grade.

If there are any extenuating circumstances preventing you from attending class in-person, please contact your instructor as soon as possible to discuss your course attendance.

COMMUNICATION WITH THE INSTRUCTOR AND TA

In-Class Discussion Facilitation: As facilitators, the course instructor and TA will share the responsibility of leading in-class discussions. The facilitator's role is to create an atmosphere in which students feel it is both expected and comfortable to engage. They will do so by asking thought-provoking questions to initiate discussion and will aim to keep each discussion on track. However, a facilitator is also learning along with students during this process.

Messages and Announcements: I will post a weekly announcement at the beginning of the week with reminders of what is expected for class that week. I'll also send logistical updates as needed. I typically post a Canvas announcement that is also forwarded to your Northeastern email. This redundancy ensures that everyone in the course sees the communication.

Office Hours: Office hours are a designated time when an instructor is available to meet with students. This time can be used for asking questions about our course or just getting to know your instructor. Office hours are a great way to grow your network on campus! I am available by appointment for any questions you may have, so feel free to email me or speak to me before or after class if you'd like to find a time to talk.

If you have **technical questions or concerns**, please visit or call Northeastern University's Online Support Center at https://its.northeastern.edu/support/ to access tutorials and live chat support or call the Center at 617-373-4357.

NORTHEASTERN UNIVERSITY ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

As members of the academic community, students must become familiar with their rights and responsibilities. In each course, they are responsible for knowing the requirements and restrictions regarding research and writing, examinations of whatever kind, collaborative work, the use of study aids, the appropriateness of assistance, and other issues. Students are responsible for learning the conventions of documentation and acknowledgment of sources in their fields. Northeastern University expects students to complete all examinations, tests, papers, creative projects, and assignments of any kind according to the highest ethical standards, as set forth either explicitly or implicitly in this Code or by the direction of instructors. For more information, please see

http://www.northeastern.edu/osccr/academic-integrity-policy/

ACCOMMODATIONS FOR STUDENTS WITH DISABILITIES

If you have a disability-related need for reasonable academic accommodations in this course and have not yet met with a Disability Specialist, please visit www.northeastern.edu/drc and follow the outlined procedure to request services.

If the Disability Resource Center has formally approved you for an academic accommodation in this class, please present the instructor with your "Professor Notification Letter" during the first week of the semester so your specific needs can be addressed as early as possible. Accommodations for assignments cannot be made without official notification from the DRC **prior** to the assignment's due date.

TITLE IX OF THE EDUCATION AMENDMENTS OF 1972

Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 protects individuals from sex or gender-based discrimination, including discrimination based on gender-identity, in educational programs and activities that receive federal financial assistance. Northeastern University's Title IX Policy prohibits Prohibited Offenses, which are defined as sexual harassment, sexual assault, relationship or domestic violence, and stalking. The Title IX Policy applies to the entire community, including male, female, transgender students, faculty and staff.

If you or someone you know has been a survivor of a Prohibited Offense, ***confidential*** support and guidance can be found through **University Health and Counseling Services** staff (http://www.northeastern.edu/uhcs/) and the **Center for Spiritual Dialogue and Service clergy members** (http://www.northeastern.edu/spirituallife/). By law, those employees are not required to report allegations of sex or gender-based discrimination to the University. Alleged violations can be reported non-confidentially to the Title IX Coordinator within ***The Office for Gender Equity and Compliance*** at: titleix@northeastern.edu and/or through **NUPD** (Emergency 617.373.3333; Non-Emergency 617.373.2121). Reporting Prohibited Offenses to NUPD does **NOT** commit the victim/affected party to future legal action.

Faculty members are considered "responsible employees" at Northeastern University, meaning they are required to report all allegations of sex or gender-based discrimination to the Title IX Coordinator.

In case of an emergency, please call 911.

Please visit https://www.northeastern.edu/ouec/ ***for a complete list of reporting options and resources both on- and off-campus.***

BASIC NEEDS

If you are facing challenges securing food or housing and believe this may affect your performance in the course, please reach out to WeCare (wecare@northeastern.edu) for support. Furthermore, please notify your instructor(s) if you are comfortable in doing so. This will enable them to provide any resources that they may possess.

KHOURY COLLEGE TECHNOLOGY RESOURCE

The Khoury Systems Knowledge Base contains helpful guides for accessing and utilizing computing resources provided by the college – this includes your Khoury account.

https://www.khoury.northeastern.edu/systems/resources/

CS 1200 requires students to upload course submissions using the Office 365 suite (including Microsoft Word). We will not accept alternative word processor submissions, so please be sure to download or bookmark your Office 365 applications, which are free to the Northeastern community: https://office365.northeastern.edu/.

TIMELINE AND GRADING

Keep in mind that grades for this course are *weighted.* Weighted grades are based on **percentages** and not points. For instance, an exam may be worth 100 points but be 15% of your grade, while homework may be worth 1,400 points but only be 10% of your overall grade. The points do not get added together. This is the main difference between weighted grades and a running total of points.

Major Assignments

Detailed descriptions of each assignment can be found in the module titled "Welcome and Introduction to CS 1200 – First Year Seminar" on Canvas. You may also find them clicking on the "Assignments" page in the Navigation Pane on Canvas.

Assignment	Description	Grade %
Participation	Read all weekly course modules and complete weekly Exit Questions; Attend in-person class sessions and display engagement in in-class activities and discussions; Attend a TA 1:1 meeting; Participate in design thinking group work and grade self and group members	40%
Design Thinking Project	Create Group ground rules, roles and responsibilities; Complete each phase worksheet with group; Receive and provide project feedback; Carry out user testing sessions; Work on feedback received; Complete design thinking group presentation	30%
Network Map	Build network of people and campus resources; Engage in events and opportunities, attend 1 CS 1200 TA-led session, attend 2 Khoury-specific events, Attend Office	15%

	hours (Faculty, Instructor, TA); reflect on network growth this semester	
First-Semester Goal Setting Reflections	Review goal setting modules and complete the three 2-page reflections throughout the course of the semester	15%
Total		**100%**

All assignments must be submitted via Canvas by the date and time posted.

All work in this course should be either original or with proper citations. Any submission that does not include proper attribution or is plagiarized will receive an automatic grade of F.

I will not accept late discussion posts, Exit questions, or Design Thinking project worksheets unless there are mitigating circumstances. If you need to request an extension, please reach out to me (not your TA) via email **before the assignment is due.** If you request an extension *after* the due date, I cannot promise to grant it.

For larger assignments (specifically: the three goal-setting reflections, Northeastern Network Map, Design Thinking Group Presentation, and Group and Self-Reflection) I will allow late submissions up until 5 days after the assigned due date. For each day it is late, there is a 10% deduction in your highest possible grade.

LARGE ASSIGNMENT LATE POLICY	
Lateness	**Maximum Grade**
15 minutes-24 hours late	90%
2 days late	80%
3 days late	70%
4 days late	60%
5 days late	50%
After 5 days	0%

GRADING SCALE			
Letter Grade	**Percentage Range**	**Letter Grade**	**Percentage Range**
A	94-100%	**C**	73-75%
A-	90-93%	**C-**	70-72%
B+	86-89%	**D+**	66-69%
B	83-85%	**D**	63-65%

B-	80-82%	**D-**	60-62%
C+	76-79%	**F**	≤ 59%

Week #/Week of	**Topic/Agenda**	**Assignments to be Completed**
Week 0/ January 17 Online	Course Introduction and Personal Introductions • Course Overview • Design Thinking overview • Introduce Yourself	Review Module 1 (Course Overview, Design Thinking Overview, and Introduce Yourself) Weekly Discussion- Introduce Yourself video (Due 11:59pm January 26th)
Week 1/ January 24 In-person	Course Introduction and Personal Introductions • Introductions • Course Overview • Design Thinking Intro	Review First-Semester Goal Setting module First-Semester Goal Setting Reflection 1- due February 9th at 11:59pm
Week 2/ January 31 Online	Working in Groups and Communication First-Semester Goal-Setting	Review modules and complete Exit Questions: Working in Groups, Communication First-Semester Goal Setting Reflection 1- due February 9th at 11:59pm
Week 3/ Feb 7 In-person	Working in Groups and Communication • Meet your group! • Group Activity • Group ground rules worksheet	Submit Group Ground Rules worksheet by February 16th at 11:59pm
Week 4/ Feb 14 Online	Community and Social Identity and Empathize Phase	Review modules and complete Exit Questions: Community, Social Identity, and Empathize Phase

Week 5/ Feb 21 In-Person	Community and Social Identity and Empathize Phase • Community Activity • Social Identity Activity • Empathize Phase group work	Submit Empathize Phase Worksheet by 11:59pm March 2nd If group finishes Empathize Phase worksheet, move on to reviewing Define Phase module (as you will be starting it next week)
Week 6/ Feb 28 In-Person	Define Phase Intro to Ideating & Problem Solving	Review module and complete Exit Questions: Define Phase, Ideating & Problem Solving • Complete and Submit Define Phase worksheet by 11:59 pm March 9th
Week 7/ March 7 Online	Ideating & Problem Solving • Review How might we? Questions • Problem-solving using campus resources activity • Ideating with group	Submit Ideation Phase worksheet by 11:59pm March 16th If group finishes Ideation Phase worksheet, move on to reviewing Prototype Phase module (as you will be starting it next week)
Week 8/ March 14 Online Spring Break	Prototyping and Testing Revisiting Goals	Review modules and complete Exit Questions: Prototyping and Testing • Complete and submit Prototype Phase worksheet (including developing your first prototype with group) by 11:59pm March 23rd Review Revisiting Your First-Semester Goals module Complete Revisiting Goals reflection by 11:59pm March 30th
Week 9/ March 21 In-person	Prototype and Testing • Prototype share out • Example testing session • User Test planning	Complete Revisiting Goals reflection by 11:59pm March 30th Complete user testing sessions and submit Testing Phase Worksheet by 11:59pm April 13th

Week 10/ March 28 online	Testing Sessions Processing Feedback and Moving Forward	Complete user testing sessions and submit Testing Phase Worksheet by 11:59pm April 13th Review Module and complete Exit Questions: Processing Feedback and Moving Forward
Week 11/ April 4 **In-Person**	**TA-Led Class** Processing Feedback and Moving Forward • User testing updates/feedback conversation • Receive prototype feedback from peers? • Feedback/moving forward activity • Review of final assignments/due dates/expectations	Complete user testing sessions and submit Testing Phase Worksheet by 11:59pm April 13th **Review final project instructions and check in with group** Design Thinking Group presentation- due 11:59pm April 21st
Week 12/ April 11 In-person	Last Class • Final Activity/Reflection • Review of final assignment due dates • Wrap-up	Design Thinking Group presentation- due 11:59pm April 21st Attendance at a TA One-on-One must be completed by 11:59pm April 22nd
Week 13/ April 18	No Class Meetings Design Thinking Group Presentation due! April 21st by 11:59pm	**Design Thinking Group presentation- due 11:59pm April 21st** **Attendance at a TA One-on-One must be completed by 11:59pm April 22nd** Complete Remaining Final Assignments- due 11:59pm May 2nd • Northeastern Network Map • First-Semester Goal Setting Reflection 3 • Group and Self-Evaluation
Due 11:59pm **May 2nd**	Northeastern Network Map First-Semester Goal Setting Reflection 3	

	Group and Self-Evaluation	